

FileBank WorkFlow

Global Administrator Manual

Step-by-step instructions for creating and looking after the customer organisations on an installation

This manual is for the people who run a FileBank WorkFlow installation for more than one organisation. Each task is a short list of steps with a picture of the screen; the button or box a step talks about is outlined in red. The pictures show demonstration customers such as Riverside Academy. Server installation is in docs/DEPLOYMENT-IIS.md; what a customer administrator does inside their own organisation is in the Administrator Manual.

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CHAPTER 1

How it works

One installation hosts many **customers** (organisations). Each has its own address, forms, people and data, and none can see any other. The **global management console** is where customers are created and looked after. It is a separate site with a separate sign-in: your account there is not a user in any customer, and no customer administrator can see it, deactivate it or reset its key.

Role	What it can do
Global administrator (you)	Create customers, rename them, move them to another address, suspend, restore and remove them, add or remove a customer's administrators, reset an administrator's key, change a customer's settings, choose a folder for its files, export its PDFs, start a time-limited support session, and look after the other global administrators.
Customer administrator	Everything inside one organisation: forms, approval chains, lookups, requests, its own people and settings. Nothing outside it.

NOTE

You cannot read a customer's requests, forms or documents from the console. When you genuinely need to see what a customer sees, use a **support session**, which is visible to them and recorded in their own audit log.

CHAPTER 2

Getting started

Sign in to the console

You need: a global administrator account.

- 1 Open **/global** on the installation address (for example <https://vwf.filebankinc.com/global>). Type your **email address** and **6-digit password key** and choose **Sign in**.

The screenshot shows the 'Global management' console interface. On the left, a dark blue sidebar contains the text 'FileBank WorkFlow · Global' at the top, followed by 'Global management' in large white letters, and a description: 'Create and look after customer organisations: their addresses, first administrators, access and support.' At the bottom of the sidebar, it says 'Customers sign in on their own address, not here.' The main content area is light gray and titled 'Sign in'. It contains two input fields: 'Email address' with the value 'qa-global@demo.test' and '6-digit password key' which is currently empty and highlighted with a red border. Below these fields is a yellow 'Sign in' button.

RESULT

The customer list opens. The console always has a **navy** top bar, where customer portals have a black one - so you can tell at a glance where you are.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Five wrong keys lock the account for 15 minutes.
- **Help** (top right) opens this manual; a copied link to it stops working after a few minutes.

Create the very first global administrator

You need: access to the server - there is nobody yet who could do it in the console.

- 1 On the server run: `npm run seed:platform-admin -- --email you@example.com --displayName "Your Name"`
- 2 A random 6-digit key is printed **once**. Sign in with it, then change it (**Administrators > Change my key**).

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Run it again with `--reset-key` for somebody who has lost their key and cannot be helped by another global administrator.

CHAPTER 3

Customers

Check on all customers

- 1 The console opens on **Customers**. The tiles count active customers, people, requests in progress and **failed emails** across all customers - a quick check that nothing is stuck anywhere.

Customer	Address	People	Forms	Requests	Last activity	
Demo Co	demo	7	2	9 (5 open)	10/1/2026, 2:50:58 PM	Open
Riverside Academy	riverside	5	6	6 (4 open)	10/1/2026, 3:26:14 PM	Open

- 2 Click a customer's name to open its page, or **Open** to open its portal's sign-in page in a new tab.

Column	Meaning
Customer	The organisation's name. Suspended means nobody there can sign in; Removed shows the date its data will be deleted.
Address	The short name its site is reached at.
People / Forms	Active user accounts / active forms.
Requests	Total requests, and how many are still open.
Last activity	The most recent audited event there. A customer with no activity for a long time is worth asking about.

Recent management activity below the list shows the last 20 things global administrators did, and who. It comes from the platform audit log, which records every action in the console and can never be changed.

Create a customer

You need: the organisation's name and the email and name of the person who will set it up.

- 1 On **Customers** choose **New customer**.
- 2 Type the **Organisation name**. The **Address** (short name) is filled in for you - lowercase letters, digits and hyphens; choose carefully, because changing it later changes what people have bookmarked. Fill **Full host name** only for a name of the customer's own such as approvals.acme.com. Type the **First administrator's email** and **name**. Optionally type a **Folder for this customer's files**.

New customer

Organisation name

Address

Lowercase letters, digits and hyphens. This is the customer's own sub-site.

Full host name (optional)

Leave blank to use the standard address for this installation.

First administrator's email

First administrator's name

Folder for this customer's files (optional)

Closed-request PDFs and approvers' attachments are saved there instead of the database. Leave blank to keep them in the database. The app checks it can write there before creating the customer.

Create customer [Cancel](#)

- 3 Choose **Create customer**.

RESULT

The organisation, its numbering, its settings and its first administrator are created together. A **first sign-in key** is shown **once**: pass it to the administrator through a channel you trust, separately from the address. They sign in, change the key, set their branding on **Settings**, build their forms and tell their colleagues the address.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- An address or host name that is already taken is refused.
- A lost first key: use **Reset key** on the customer's page rather than creating a second customer.

Rename a customer or change its address

- 1 Open the customer. Under **Address and status** change the **Organisation name**, the **Host name** or the **Notification address** (where alerts go when nobody more specific applies; blank means every administrator). Choose **Save**.

Address and status

Organisation name
Riverside Academy

Host name
riverside...

Currently reached at <http://riverside.approvalflow.localhost:5173>. Changing this needs a matching DNS entry.

Notification address
admin@riverside.test

Where alerts go when nobody more specific applies. Blank means every administrator.

Save **Suspend this customer**

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

A new host name works only once DNS points that name at this installation (and, for a name of its own, a certificate and IIS binding exist). Arrange that first, or people will find nothing there.

Suspend or reactivate a customer

- 1 Open the customer. Under **Address and status** choose **Suspend this customer**, then **Yes, suspend it**.
- 2 To undo it, choose **Reactivate**.

RESULT

Suspended: nobody can sign in, everybody signed in is signed out within moments, and scheduled reminders stop. Nothing is deleted; **Reactivate** puts everything back exactly as it was. Use it for non-payment, an offboarding or a security incident.

Remove a customer that has left

You need: a suspended customer.

- 1 Open the customer. In **Remove this customer** at the bottom, type the customer's short address name exactly as shown.
- 2 Choose **Remove customer**.

RESULT

The customer is frozen for **30 days** and the list shows the date its data will be deleted. Then everything it owns is deleted for good: people, forms, requests and decisions, lookups, settings, its audit log, PDFs and emails, and the files the app wrote to its folder.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- To undo it, open the customer and choose **Restore this customer** before that date. It comes back suspended; choose **Reactivate** when its people may sign in again.
- Export anything the customer may want before the date - after it the deletion cannot be undone. The grace period is set on the server with `TENANT_REMOVAL_DAYS`.

CHAPTER 4

Looking after a customer

Add an administrator to a customer

- 1 Open the customer. Under **Administrators**, in **Add an administrator**, type the **Email** - and the **Full name** if the person has no account there yet. Choose **Add administrator**.

Administrators

Name	Email	Key	
Alex Admin	admin@riverside.test	Set	Reset key Remove

Add an administrator

Email

bursar@riverside.test

Full name

Bea Bursar

Anyone can be added. Someone who already has an account here just becomes an administrator (the name is not needed). Someone new gets an account - enter their name - and an email telling them how to sign in; they choose their own key. Any email address is accepted, even outside the organisation's allowed domains.

Add administrator

RESULT

Someone with an account gets the Admin role and keeps their other roles; someone deactivated is reactivated with it. Someone new gets an account with no key and an email **"Your account for <organisation>"**; at their first sign-in they confirm the address with a code and choose their own key. They show **Not set yet** under Key until then. Recorded in the console's audit log and the customer's own.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Any address is accepted, even outside the customer's allowed email domains (for example an outside consultant); that setting only limits people registering themselves.

Remove an administrator, or reset their key

- 1 Open the customer. In the **Administrators** list choose **Remove** to take the Admin role away (the account stays, with its other roles).
- 2 Or choose **Reset key**, then **Yes, reset it**: their key stops working, and at their next sign-in they prove their email with a code and choose a new one. You never see either key.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Never leave an organisation with no administrator - its people would be locked out of their own configuration until you grant the role again.

Export a customer's PDFs

- 1 Open the customer. Under **Export PDFs** choose the **Form**, the **Submitted from** and **to** dates and the **Outcome**, then **Check**: it shows how many PDFs match and the ZIP's name.

Export PDFs

One form's approved and/or rejected requests, by the date they were **submitted**: a ZIP with every PDF and an Excel file **Index.xlsx** listing each one - file name (a link to the PDF), request, status, people, dates, approval steps and the form's own fields. At most 500 PDFs at a time.

Form: Submitted from: to: Outcome:

2 PDFs will be exported as **Purchase-R_PDFs_01102026-01102026.zip**.

- 2 Choose **Download ZIP**.

RESULT

A ZIP of every PDF under its usual name plus **Index.xlsx** - one row per PDF with a link to it, the request's details, its approval steps and the form's fields. It is the same export the customer's administrators have under Requests. Recorded as **tenant.pdfs_exported** in the console and **pdf.exported** (with your email as changedBy) in the customer's log.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

At most **500 PDFs** at a time - narrow the dates for more.

Keep a customer's files in a folder of its own

You need: a folder on a drive of the server or a network share, with **Modify** permission for the Windows account the app runs as (and on the share).

- 1 Open the customer. Under **File storage** type the full path - **D:\CustomerFiles\Acme** (not a whole drive) or **\\fileservers\approvals\Acme** - and choose **Use this folder**.

RESULT

The app proves it can write there before saving. From now on the customer's PDFs and approvers' documents are saved there, **one sub-folder per day submitted** (2026-09-28); documents are named after their request and step (REQ-000014_Step-1_Supplier quote.pdf). Nothing is ever overwritten, and the customer never sees the path.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- If the app cannot write there it says why and nothing changes.
- Only **new** files go there; older files stay where they are and still open. **Keep new files in the database instead** switches back the same way.
- The app keeps each file's fingerprint and refuses one changed or removed outside it - back the folder up, and restore from the backup if that happens.

Change a customer's settings

- 1 Open the customer and scroll to **Settings**: branding, who may register and the email sender - exactly as their own administrator sees it.
- 2 Make the change and choose **Save settings**.

RESULT

The change is recorded in the customer's audit log with your email beside it, so nothing you do there is invisible to them.

Help a customer with a support session

You need: an active customer and a reason - a ticket number is ideal.

- 1 Open the customer. Under **Support access** type **Why** and choose **Start support session**.

Support access

Opens this customer's portal as one of its administrators, for 30 minutes. It is recorded in this customer's own audit log, and everything done during it is stamped with your name - the customer can see exactly what happened.

Why (recorded in the audit log)

Ticket 4821 - form will not publish

Start support session

- 2 Choose **Open the portal**. Their portal opens as one of their administrators, with a banner for the whole session.

RESULT

The session lasts **30 minutes** and can do no more than that administrator could. Its start and reason are recorded as **user.impersonation_started**, and everything done during it is stamped **impersonatedByPlatformAdmin** in their audit log.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

A suspended customer cannot be opened. Treat a session like remote control of somebody's desk: do what was asked and nothing else, and prefer the console's Settings for configuration changes.

Add the sample forms to a customer

You need: a customer with an administrator and at least one approver.

- 1 On the server run: `npm --prefix server run sample:forms -- --tenant <address name>` (for example --tenant acme).

RESULT

Five sample forms with approval chains are added - Leave Request, Mileage Reimbursement, IT Access & Equipment Request, Records Retrieval Request and Secure Destruction Authorization - using the customer's own approvers and its Departments and Schools lookup tables if it has them. A form that already exists is left alone.

CHAPTER 5

Global administrators

Add a global administrator

- 1 Choose **Administrators** in the top bar, then **New global administrator**. Type their **email address** and **name**.

The screenshot shows the 'Global administrators' page in the FileBank WorkFlow - Global interface. The top navigation bar includes 'FileBank WorkFlow - Global', 'Customers', and 'Administrators'. The 'Administrators' section is active. Below the navigation bar, there is a 'Global administrators' section with a 'New global administrator' button highlighted in a yellow box. Below this button is a table with columns: Name, Email, Status, Last sign-in, and Added. The table contains two entries: 'Global Admin' with email 'admin@filebankinc.com' and 'QA Global (local test) (you)' with email 'qa-global@demo-test'. Both are 'Active'. Below the table is a 'Change my key' section with three input fields: 'Current key', 'New key', and 'New key again'. A 'Change key' button is at the bottom of this section.

Name	Email	Status	Last sign-in	Added
Global Admin	admin@filebankinc.com	Active	9/28/2026, 12:07:08 PM	9/26/2026
QA Global (local test) (you)	qa-global@demo-test	Active	10/1/2026, 3:25:14 PM	9/30/2026

- 2 A 6-digit key is generated and shown **once**. Pass it to them through a channel you trust; they change it after signing in.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

A global administrator can create, change, suspend and remove every customer. Add only people who need that, and give each person their own account.

Look after the other global administrators

- 1 On **Administrators** choose **New key** for somebody who has lost theirs (shown once; the old key stops working).
- 2 Choose **Deactivate** when somebody leaves - they are blocked at once and any open session ends. **Reactivate** lets them back.
- 3 Use **Change my key** for your own key: the current key and the new one twice.

RESULT

Every change is in the platform audit log with who made it. Nobody can deactivate themselves or give themselves a new key here, so there is always at least one active global administrator.

CHAPTER 6

Reference

How an address decides the organisation

The address in the browser decides which organisation a request belongs to. A person in two customers has **two separate accounts** with separate keys; a key from one never works at the other address. Every link in every email uses the organisation's own address.

With a wildcard DNS record and certificate (see docs/DEPLOYMENT-IIS.md), a new customer needs **no server work** - creating it in the console is enough. A customer with a name of its own needs a DNS entry, a certificate and an IIS binding, then its **Host name** set on its page.

What is shared and what is not

Kept apart per customer	Shared by the installation
Forms, requests, documents, lookups, users, audit log	The server, the database and the mail server
Branding, sign-up rules, sender address	The default values those settings fall back to
Archived PDFs and documents (database or the customer's folder)	The database, or the server or share holding the folders

Separation is enforced in the database itself: every table carries the organisation, child rows can only point at a parent in the same organisation, and a query that does not say which organisation it means is rejected.

Everyday tasks

Situation	What to do
A new customer is joining	Create a customer ; send the address and the first key separately; point their administrator to the Administrator Manual.
The first administrator lost the key	Open the customer, Reset key beside them.
Their administrator has left	Add an administrator for the replacement, then Remove the old one.
Emails are not arriving	Check Failed emails on the customer list, then the customer's sender address in Settings. The mail server itself is installation-wide.
They report something you cannot see	Ask for the request number and start a support session with it as the reason.
Non-payment or an incident	Suspend the customer. Nothing is deleted.
A customer has left for good	Suspend it, then Remove customer . Restorable for 30 days.
Somebody asks what you did in their organisation	Their own audit log has every action of yours; support-session actions are stamped as such.
A customer wants its files on its own drive	Give the app's account Modify permission, then set File storage on its page.

Keeping your own account safe

- Your account can create, suspend and enter every organisation, so use a key nobody else knows and that you use nowhere else.
- Sign out when you are finished, particularly on a shared machine. A support session ends on its own; your console session does not.
- Never share a global administrator account - the platform audit log is only useful if it names a person.